out during my early speech-making days in Hollywood, I developed a shorthand I've used ever since.

I began listing the main points I wanted to make in a speech on four-by-six-inch cards with abbreviations for some words: "That," for example, became "tht," "barren desert" would be "barrn dsrt." Just the letters told me what the word was, and usually other words in a sentence would be so obvious to me when I looked down at the card, I'd remember the rest. I might include three or four words to remind me of a story or joke that I wanted to tell, then I'd ad lib the rest. (Of course, this hasn't done much for my spelling now when I write a note to someone.) Let me take that sentence and show how I'd compress it: ". . . cours ths hsnt don much . . . my splng now whn . . . write . . . note . . . sm one."

Although GE gave me a platform, it left it up to me to decide what to say. As a liberal in my younger days I'd had an inherent suspicion of big business and couldn't believe there wouldn't come a day when the company would begin trying to write my speeches for me. Never once did that happen.

In 1958, our second child, Ron, was born, bringing more joy into our lives. In 1960, after leading the Screen Actors Guild in its first major strike in history in my fifth term as president, I resigned after becoming a partner in a production company, and therefore, from the union's point of view, I was no longer a working stiff but a producer.

Some authors have suggested my work in the Screen Actors Guild fighting the studios hurt my film career, as it had hurt some of the early pioneers in the union, but I've never felt any sour grapes about it. To a newspaper columnist who asked, after the 1960 strike, if I thought the union work had hurt my career, I said, "I think it has hurt some, although certainly not in the way that someone says, 'I'm mad at this guy so I won't use him in my pictures.' In all